

Fixing SharpFont / Freetype6 DLL Errors in a 64-bit Project

Problem:

SharpFont loads the wrong native DLL (freetype6.dll from the x86 folder), which causes:

```
DllNotFoundException: Unable to load DLL 'freetype6'
Could not copy ... x86\freetype6.dll ... file not found
```

This happens because the SharpFont NuGet package includes both x86 and x64 DLLs, and MSBuild sometimes selects the incorrect one.

Solution Steps

Step 1 — Remove all x86 native DLL folders

Delete the x86 folders inside the package directory:

```
packages\SharpFont.Dependencies.2.6\bin\msvc9\x86\
packages\SharpFont.Dependencies.2.6\bin\msvc10\x86\
packages\SharpFont.Dependencies.2.6\bin\msvc11\x86\
packages\SharpFont.Dependencies.2.6\bin\msvc12\x86\
```

This prevents MSBuild from trying to copy the wrong DLL.

Step 2 — Update the SharpFont.Dependencies.props file

Edit:

```
packages\SharpFont.Dependencies.2.6\build\SharpFont.Dependencies.props
```

Replace its contents with:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<Project ToolsVersion="4.0" xmlns="http://schemas.microsoft.com/developer/msbuild

  <!-- Only include the x64 DLL when building for x64 -->
  <ItemGroup Condition="'$(Platform)'=='x64'">
```

```
<Content Include="$(MSBuildThisFileDirectory)..\bin\msvc10\x64\freetype6.dll"  
  <CopyToOutputDirectory>PreserveNewest</CopyToOutputDirectory>  
</Content>  
</ItemGroup>  
  
</Project>
```

This forces the build system to always choose the **x64** version of freetype6.dll .

Step 3 — Copy freetype6.dll to your project output

Copy the **x64** DLL into your project directory or output directory:

```
YourProject\bin\x64\Debug\
```

(or wherever your executable runs)

This ensures the runtime loader can find it.